

Africa

Step Pyramid of Zoser

Location Sakkara, Egypt

The Step Pyramid of Zoser, located about 19 miles (30 km) south of Cairo, sits in the vast burial grounds of the ancient Egyptian capital of Memphis. The structure is both the world's earliest stone monument and Egypt's first pyramid. It was commissioned in around 2600 BCE by Pharaoh Zoser (or "Djoser") and was designed by the architect Imhotep. Reaching some 197 ft (60 m) high, the pyramid is made of small limestone blocks arranged in stacked layers that

look like giant steps. Built around a *mastaba*—a type of tomb in which the pharaohs of ancient Egypt were buried—it was the centerpiece of a complex that included courtyards, shrines, a temple, and priests' dwellings.

Fortress of Buhen

Location Buhen, Egypt

Located on the west bank of the River Nile, in the region of Nubia (currently on the northern edge of Sudan), the Fortress of Buhen was built during the reigns of Senwosret I and Senwosret III in the 12th Dynasty of ancient Egypt (c.1990–1800 BCE). Stretching some 490 ft (150 m) along the river, the fortress covered an area of 140,000

square ft (13,000 square m). Its outer walls, made of stone and bricks, are up to 16 ft (5 m) thick and 33 ft (10 m) high. Inside the walls was a town with a population of more than 3,000 people. The complex also included a temple of Horus. The fortress became completely submerged during floods in the 20th century and is now part of Lake Nasser.

Temple of Queen Hatshepsut

Location Der El-Bahari, Egypt

Situated on the west bank of the Nile, near the Valley of the Kings and the cliffs of Der El-Bahari, the huge temple of Queen Hatshepsut is one of

Egypt's best known architectural masterpieces. Featuring several colonnaded platforms arranged over different levels and linked by steps and ramps, this majestic monument was built from masonry and cut stone as a mortuary temple to honor one of ancient Egypt's first female pharaohs. Built between 1490 and 1460 BCE by architect and royal chancellor Senenmut, the structure is adorned with striking reliefs and pillared porticos.

Valley of the Kings

Location Luxor, Egypt

Located across the Nile from the ancient city of Thebes (modern Luxor),



▲ THE TEMPLE OF QUEEN HATSHEPSUT NESTLED IN THE DER EL-BAHARI